

action. This is because at the heart of an Automator action is AppleScript! That means that any application that's scriptable can have its own set of Automator actions. Combined with AppleScript, imagination (and skill, of course) is the limit to what Automator can do. For example, one can have a unique set of custom written actions for doing routine tasks in Photoshop!



Using Automator workflows within Finder

While the creating of such actions is beyond the scope of this article as it requires intricate knowledge of AppleScript, we shall look at some of the popular custom actions and workflows based thereon.

Actions can be found on Apple's Automator download section (<http://www.apple.com/downloads/macosex/automator.html>) as well as on independent sites like Automator World (<http://automatorworld.com/>) and Automator.us. Some of our favourites:

Photoshop CS Automator Actions 3.5

Now here's a comprehensive collection of 86 actions specially scripted for Adobe's Photoshop. From adding layers, rendering clouds, blurs, to adding graphic watermarks for all your digital images. And since Automator's actions are independent of the application, one automates the entire process of processing images to burning them to DVDs or publishing them to the Web.

Upload to Flickr 1.0 / Imageshack Uploader

A very simple action, but extremely useful nonetheless. This uploads images to the Flickr web photo storage service or Imageshack respectively.